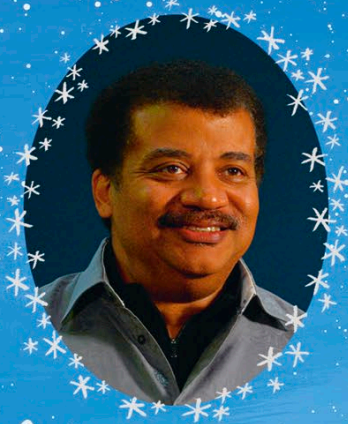




NEIL DEGRASSE TYSON

American astrophysicist and science
communicator • 1958–present

When Neil deGrasse Tyson was nine years old, he visited the Hayden Planetarium in New York City for the first time. A planetarium is a theater that is built to share the wonders of the night sky. Instead of looking across at a stage, the audience gazes up at pictures projected on a curved ceiling. As Neil looked up at the starry dome, he was full of amazement and bursting with questions. He studied physics and astronomy, and then trained as an astrophysicist, using his mind to explore the universe far beyond where we can possibly travel.

Neil completed several university degrees in the 1980s and did valuable research to help us understand more about the structure of galaxies and the way stars form and die over time. His work was so impressive that in 1996, Neil got his dream job, as director of the Hayden Planetarium itself.



*Millions of people learned more about the universe thanks to Neil's film, *Cosmos: A Spacetime Odyssey*.*

